six-hour oxygen supply organised by the KGB's Directorate 'S'),[101] the Lok Dal government didn't bother to discuss the situation even once in its official meetings.[102] Domestically oriented, Charan Singh did not take much note even of Amin's fresh round of political crackdowns against his adversaries when he realised that he had lost Moscow's support. Little did Amin know that Sarwari, along with his other three comrades, and Parcham leader Babrak Karmal, in response, would guide a column of Soviet tanks across the Hindu Kush on Christmas Day that same year. Not just Amin, even India's premier intelligence agency, the R&AW, was 'caught napping' when the Soviet troops entered Afghanistan.[103]

Conclusion

The three causal drivers of India's Afghanistan policy, i.e. desire to strike a balance between Afghanistan and Pakistan, international political postures, and Afghanistan's domestic politics (the origins of which lie in the pre- and post-independence political history) are mostly in confluence but can also be at odds with each other. The 1950s, for instance, allowed New Delhi to bond with Kabul using Asian and African resurgence as an international platform. This internationalist approach had the support of most domestic political actors in both India and Afghanistan, and did little to create an imbalance in Afghanistan's (or India's) relations with Pakistan. The 1960s, however, were dominated by heightening Cold War tensions and India's wars with Pakistan and China that challenged the utility of India's non-alignment posture. Nonetheless, consensus in Kabul and New Delhi did not allow regional and domestic instability to undermine bilateral relations and imparted continuity to the relationship. The 1970s, however, fundamentally altered the domestic, regional, and international dynamics of both India and Afghanistan.

Both these countries tilted towards the Soviet Union in light of their rivalry with Pakistan (and also China, for India) during the 1970s. This tilt explains India's uncritical acceptance of Daud's coup, the subsequent Saur Revolution, and the excesses of both these regimes. With domestic Afghan and Indian politics becoming increasingly fractured, siding with Moscow on the Afghan question